

MY JOB SEARCH IN DATA

648

**job applications in seven months.
I tracked every email.
Here is what the numbers say.**

My applications: every confirmation, rejection, test and interview invite in my Gmail, matched to its role.
The market: Profesia.sk data for the same period.
Focus: Bratislava, finance and data roles.

THE MARKET I APPLIED INTO

About 230,000 job postings in Slovakia in 12 months

July 2025 to June 2026, Profesia.sk. Only about 7,700 of them were finance and accounting roles in the Bratislava region.

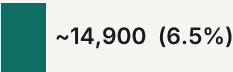
All postings, Slovakia



Bratislava region



Finance & accounting, Slovakia



Finance & accounting, Bratislava region



Estimates. Totals: Profesia 2025 annual and H1 2026 reports. Bratislava share: 35.4% (2025). Finance share from a Profesia snapshot on 26 Sep 2026 (1,086 of ~16,750 live postings; 559 in Bratislava region).

WHY IT FELT HARDER

Fewer jobs. More people applying to each one.

Profesia.sk market data.

-16%

job postings in 2025
vs 2024 (249,136 total)

-14%

job postings in H1 2026
vs H1 2025 (117,830 total)

29

applications per posting,
2025 average (+17% y/y)

36

applications per posting,
H1 2026 average

In the Bratislava region alone, postings fell 17% in 2025 to about 88,100.
Average offered salary there: 1,721 EUR per month.

COMPETITION MATH

About 7,700 finance jobs in Bratislava. 29 to 36 applicants each, on average.

Bratislava region, July 2025 to June 2026, using Profesia's average number of applications per posting.

~7,700

finance & accounting postings,
Bratislava region, Jul 2025 to Jun 2026

29 to 36

applications per posting
(2025 average, H1 2026 average)

**~220,000
to 280,000**

applications competing
for those postings

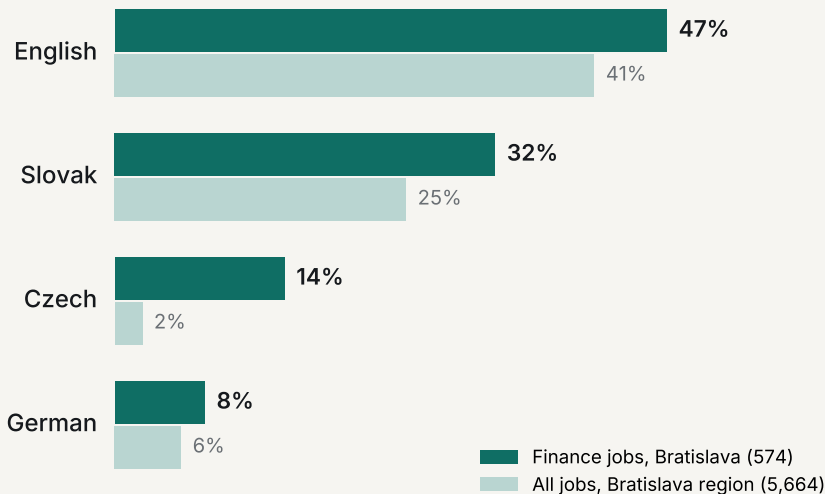
648

applications of mine,
across all roles and cities

Estimate. Applications per posting is Profesia's average across all fields; finance roles may differ.

Nearly half of Bratislava finance jobs ask for English. A third ask for Slovak.

Share of live postings naming each language, Profesia, 26 Sep 2026.
A posting can name several languages, so bars do not add up to 100%.

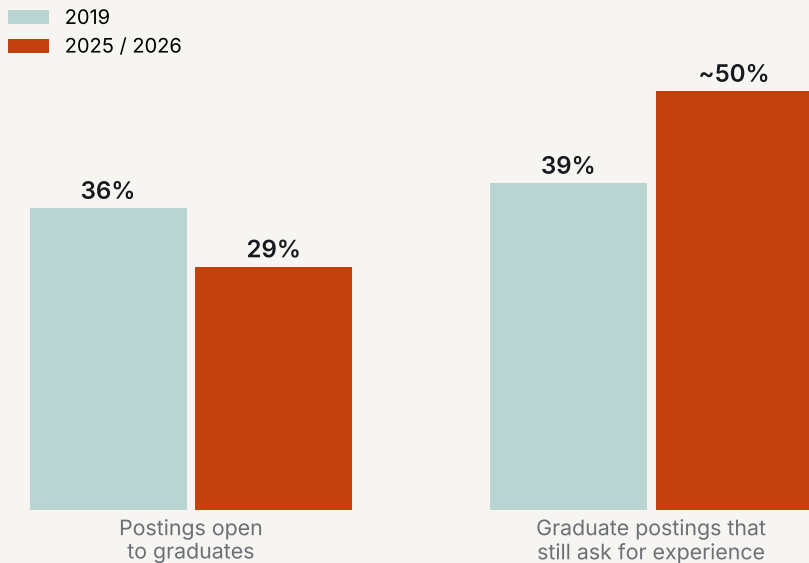


Across Slovakia, ads asking for a foreign language offered about 300 EUR more per month (1,876 vs 1,576 EUR, Profesia, Sep 2025).

ENTRY LEVEL

Fewer jobs for graduates. More of them want experience.

Profesia data on postings marked suitable for graduates, via TASR (Apr 2026).

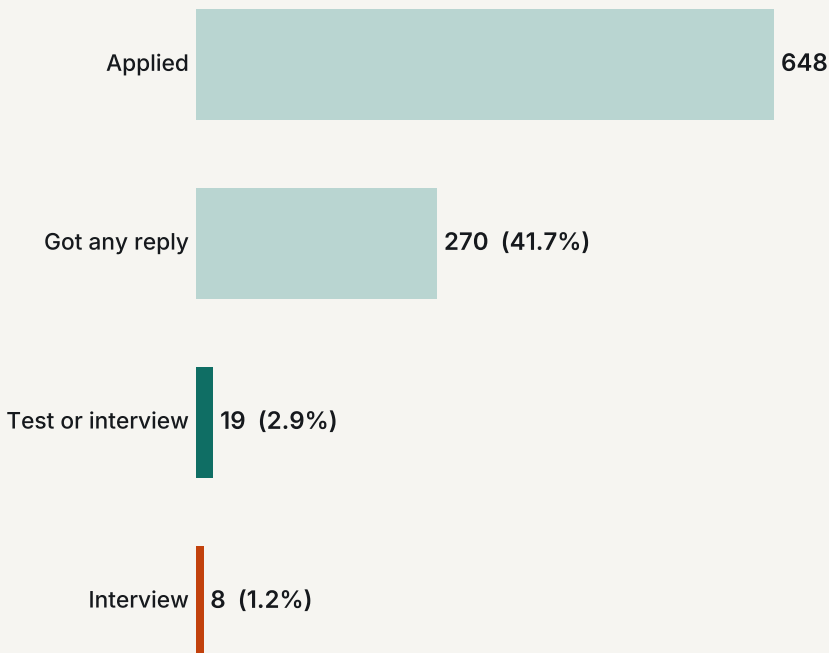


2025: 72,100 postings were marked suitable for graduates (29% of all).
In Bratislava finance today, only 13 of 574 postings are internships (2%).

THE FUNNEL

1 in 81 applications became an interview

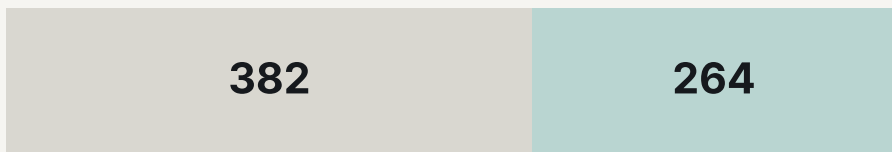
270 of 648 applications got any reply at all. 19 led to a test or interview.



OUTCOMES

59% ended in silence.
41% ended in rejection.

Final status of every application, as of September 2026.



Silence (ghosted): 382 (59.0%)

Rejected: 264 (40.7%)

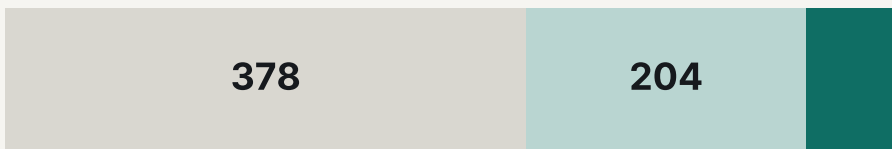
Withdrawn by me: 2 (0.3%)

251 of the 270 first replies were rejections. Silence includes 5 roles that went quiet after a test or interview.

WHO ACTUALLY REPLIED

Only 6 of my 648 applications ever got a personally written email

Bar: the first reply to each application, classified from the sender and the text.
Templates signed by a named recruiter count as templates, not personal.



■ No reply: 378 (58.3%)

■ Automated system email: 204 (31.5%)

■ Standard template, named recruiter: 62 (9.6%)

■ Written personally: 4 (0.6%)

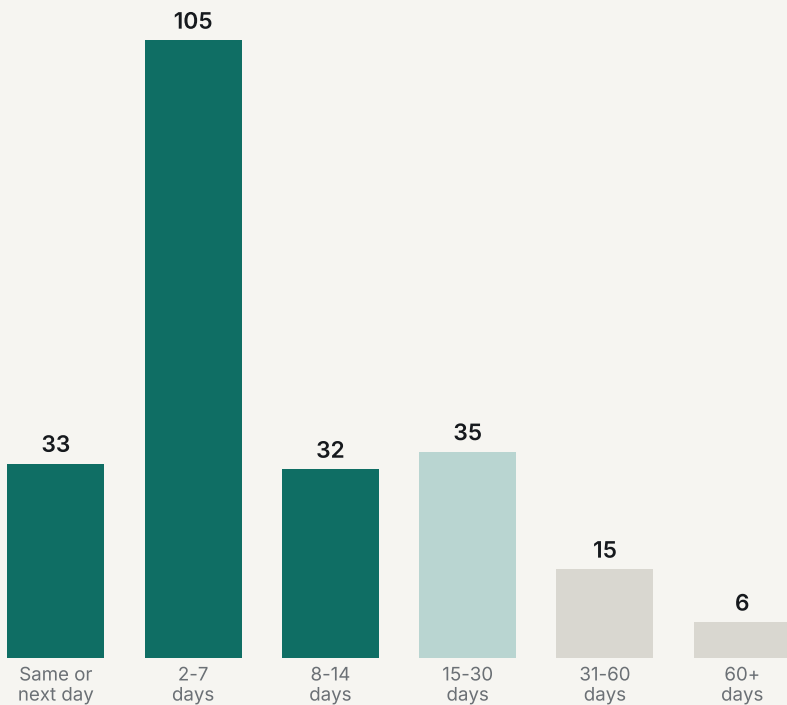
2 more got a personal email later in the process, after a first automated reply.

25 rejections arrived the same or next day after applying,
21 of them from an automated system.

TIMING

If they reply, it is usually within two weeks

Median time to first reply: 6 days. 75% of replies came within 14 days, 91% within 30.

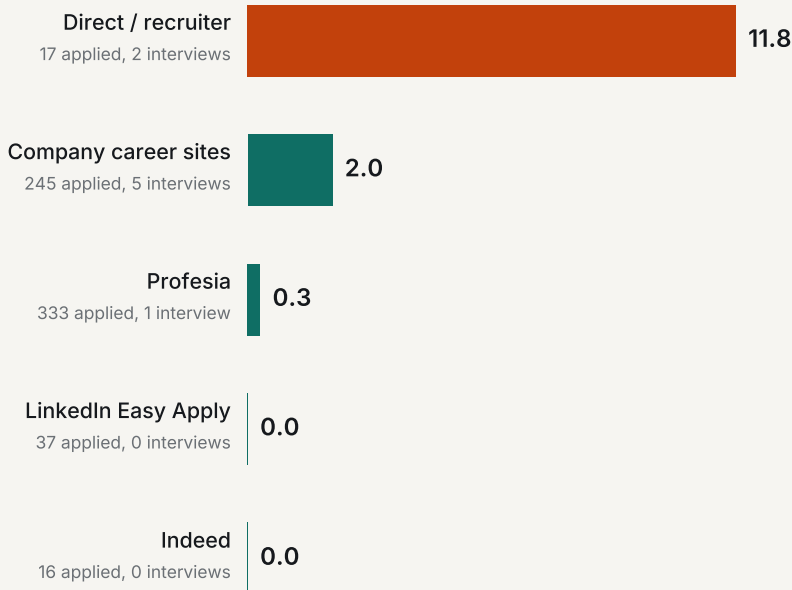


WHERE I APPLIED

Job boards gave me volume. Direct contact gave me interviews.

Interviews per 100 applications, by channel.

The direct sample is small (17), so read it as a signal, not a law.

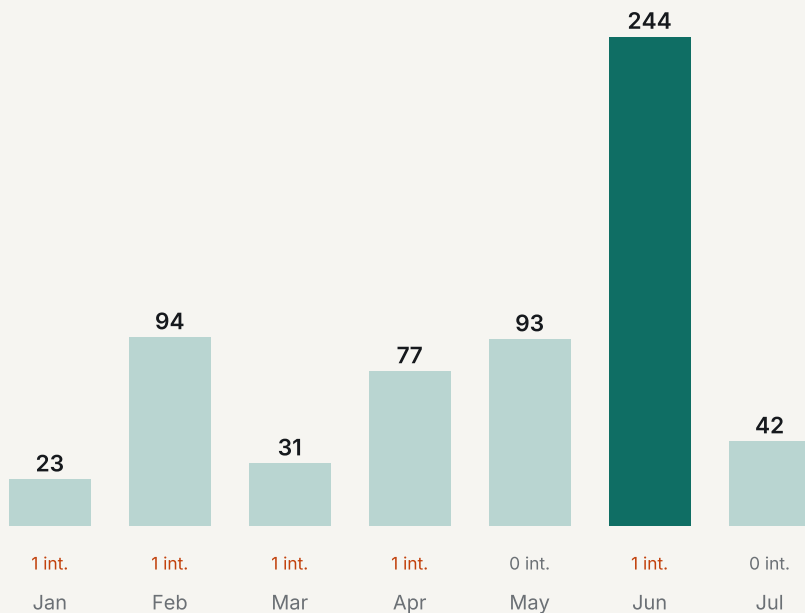


VOLUME

My busiest month: 244 applications. Interviews from it: 1.

Applications sent per month, and the interviews they led to.

3 of the 8 interviews have no application email, so they are not shown here.



Five lessons from 648 rows

01 Volume was not the bottleneck.

244 applications in June led to 1 interview. Next time: fewer roles, a CV tailored to each one.

02 Go direct when you can.

Recruiter and direct email contact: 2 interviews from 17. Profesia: 1 from 333. LinkedIn Easy Apply and Indeed: 0.

03 Give it two weeks, then move on.

75% of replies arrived within 14 days and 91% within 30. After a month, silence was the answer.

04 Check the language line first.

In Bratislava finance, 32% of postings ask for Slovak and 14% for Czech. I now read that line before anything else.

05 Track everything.

I only saw these patterns once every application was a row in a spreadsheet.